

S Yağmur Kiper

she/her/hers

updated: Feb 10, 2026

Department of Linguistics, University of California Santa Cruz

Santa Cruz, CA 95064

ykipper@ucsc.edu | yagmurkipper.github.io

Research Interests

Primary theoretical syntax; C/case, ellipsis, copular clauses, nominalizations
Secondary theoretical semantics; evidentiality, modality, aspect

Education

2022–2027 **Ph.D. in Linguistics**
University of California, Santa Cruz
Committee: Mia Gong & Maziar Toosarvandani (co-chairs), Ivy Sichel

2020–2022 **Ph.D. Studies in Language Studies**
Middle East Technical University, Ankara

2017–2020 **M.A. in English Language Teaching, Language Studies**
Middle East Technical University, Ankara
Thesis: *In the case of sluicing* (awarded best thesis '21)
Committee: Martina Gračanin-Yüksek (chair), Bilal Kırkıcı, İsa Kerem Bayırlı

2013–2017 **B.A. in Foreign Language Education**
Middle East Technical University, Ankara

Appointments

2017–2019 **Lecturer, Department of Foreign Languages**
TOBB University of Economics and Technology

Papers

Conference Proceedings

forthcoming **Kiper, Y.** Ellipsis as leverage for dependent case theory. *Proceedings of the Fifty-Sixth Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society*. GLSA.

2022 **Kiper, S. Y.** [The position of the Q-like particle *ki* in Turkish and consequences for sluicing](#). In Marianne Huijsmans & Sander Nederveen (eds.), *Proceedings of the Northwest Linguistics Conference 37*. Vancouver, BC: UBCWPL.

Manuscripts

- in prep **Kiper, Y.** What does disconnectivity tell us about ellipsis?
- 2020 **Kiper, S. Y.** *In the case of sluicing* [Master of Arts Thesis]. Middle East Technical University, OpenMETU.

Edited Volumes

- 2025 Webster, N., Y. **Kiper**, H. Wang, & L. Lyu (eds). *Proceedings of the 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL41)*. Cascadilla Press.

Presentations

Peer-reviewed

- upcoming **Kiper, Y. & Knick, E.** Perfect-like meanings in Turkish via temporal adverbials. *11th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+11)*, MIT, Boston.
- 2025 **Kiper, Y.** Ellipsis as leverage for dependent case. *56th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society (NELS 56)*, NYU, New York.
- 2025 **Kiper, Y.** Low sluicing is VPE. *Talk at the 101st Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA)*, Philadelphia.
- 2021 **Kiper, S. Y.** (Mis)matches in Turkish sluicing constructions. *Short Talk at Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)*, Université de Paris, online.
- 2021 **Kiper, S. Y.** Connectivity in Turkish sluicing. *Talk at the 23rd Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG 23)*, Sogang University, online.
- 2021 **Kiper, S. Y.** The position of the Q-like particle *ki* in Turkish and consequences for sluicing. *Talk at the 37th Annual Northwest Linguistics Conference (NWLC 37)*, University of British Columbia, online.
- 2017 **Kiper, S. Y.** L1 Turkish transfer in the acquisition of L2 English definite article. *Talk at the 11th Student Conference on Linguistics (DÖK 11)*, Mersin University, Türkiye.

2016 **Kiper, S. Y.** L1 Turkish transfer in the acquisition of L2 English definite article. *Talk at the T.W.I.S.T. Conference in Linguistics (TWISTx10)*, Leiden University, Netherlands.

Invited

upcoming **Kiper, Y.** TBD. *Talk at the Syntax & Semantics Circle (SSCircle)*, University of California Berkeley.

2025 **Kiper, Y.** The Interaction between Low Sluicing and Case Licensing. *Talk at the Syntax and Morphology Circle (SMircle)*, Stanford University.

Local

2025 **Kiper, Y.** Ellipsis as leverage for dependent case theory. *Talk at the Syntax & Semantics Circle (SCircle)*, 10 Oct, UC Santa Cruz.

2025 **Kiper, Y.** Ellipsis meets case: an analysis of low sluicing and its interaction with case theory. *Talk at the Syntax & Semantics Circle (SCircle)*, 2 May, UC Santa Cruz.

2025 **Kiper, Y.** The semantics of imperfectives in Turkish. *Talk at the Spring Research Symposium (SRS)*, 11 Apr, UC Santa Cruz.

2024 **Kiper, Y.** Low sluicing in Turkish is VPE. *Talk at the Spring Research Symposium (SRS)*, 19 Apr, UC Santa Cruz.

Experience

Teaching

2023–present **Teaching Assistant**
Department of Linguistics, UC Santa Cruz

LING 116: Semantics II	Adrian Brasoveanu	Winter 2026
LING 53: Syntax I	Roumyana Pancheva	Fall 2025
LING 113: Syntax II	Ivy Sichel	Spring 2025
LING 116: Semantics II	Jess Law	Winter 2025
LING 53: Semantics I	Pranav Anand	Fall 2024
LING 53: Semantics I	Yaqing Cao	Summer 2024
LING 50: Introduction to Linguistics	Andrew Angeles	Spring 2024
LING 80D: Language and Mind	Rachel Walker	Winter 2024
LING 112: Syntax I	Ivy Sichel	Fall 2023

2019–2022

Teaching Assistant

Department of Foreign Language Education, Middle East Technical University

FLE 433: Advanced Syntax	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Spring 2022
FLE 337: Aspects of Bi-/Multi-lingualism	Hale Işık Güler	Spring 2022
FLE 134: Contextual Grammar II	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Fall 2021
FLE 307: Language Acquisition	Çiğdem Sağın Şimşek	Fall 2021
FLE 333: Introduction to Syntax	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Fall 2021
FLE 337: Aspects of Bi-/Multi-lingualism	Bilal Kırkıcı	Spring 2021
FLE 261: Linguistics II	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Spring 2021
FLE 146: Linguistics I	Hale Işık Güler	Fall 2020
FLE 425: School Experience	Işıl Günseli Kaçar	Fall 2020
FLE 420: Practice Teaching	Çiler Hatipoğlu	Spring 2020
FLE 426: The English Lexicon	Duygu Özge	Spring 2020
FLE 251: Critical Reading & Writing	Işıl Günseli Kaçar	Fall 2019

2017–2019

Instructor of Record

Department of Foreign Languages, TOBB University of Economics and Technology

ING 003: Professional Writing Skills

ING 002: Academic English II

ING 001: Academic English I

Language Skills

English Grammar

Mentoring

2025

Mentor

Science Internship Program

2024–2025

Mentor

[SLUG Career Mentorship Program](#), UC Santa Cruz

2024

Speaker

Applying to Grad School Workshop, Department of Linguistics at UC Santa Cruz

Non-degree Training

2023

The 5th Crete Summer School of Linguistics (CreteLing)

University of Crete, Greece

2021

The NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (NYI)

Online

2019

DGfS xPrag Summer School

Leibniz-Centre General Linguistics (ZAS), Germany

2016

Erasmus Exchange in British and American Studies

University of Konstanz, Germany

Awards & Fellowships

2026	<i>Graduate Pedagogy Fellow</i> , UC Santa Cruz Teaching & Learning Center (\$2000)
2025	<i>Humanities Summer Research Fellowship</i> , UC Santa Cruz Humanities Institute (\$2500)
2024	<i>Humanities Summer Fellowship</i> , UC Santa Cruz Humanities Institute (\$3500)
2023	<i>Humanities Summer Fellowship</i> , UC Santa Cruz Humanities Institute (\$5000)
2022–2023	<i>Regents Fellowship</i> , UC Santa Cruz Department of Linguistics (\$24,000)
2022	<i>Graduate Student Success Fellowship</i> , UC Santa Cruz Humanities Institute (\$1500)
2021	<i>Best Graduate Thesis Award</i> , Middle East Technical University
2020	<i>Tuition Fellowship for Summer School</i> , The NYI Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (\$225, declined)
2017–2019	<i>National Scholarship Program for MA Students</i> , The Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TÜBİTAK) (\$9000)
2016	<i>Erasmus+ Grant for the Student Exchange Program</i> , Turkish National Agency and European Union (€2000)

Service

at University of California Santa Cruz

2025–2026	Graduate Student Representative, Department of Linguistics
2024–2025	Member, Equity in Linguistics (EquiL)
2023–2024	Coordinator, Syntax & Semantics Circle (S-Circle)
2023	Organizing Committee Member, The 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL 41)
2022–2024	Member, Linguistics Events Committee

at Middle East Technical University

2021–2022	Coordinator, Technical and Technological Support Group
2021–2022	Co-organizer, Formal Linguistics Meetings
2020–2021	Co-organizer, 34th National Conference on Turkish Linguistics (UDK 34)
2016–2017	Co-organizer, Colloquium Talk Series in Linguistics & Literature
2016	Co-founder, Language Studies Society

Skills

Languages	Turkish (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate), Korean (research), Khalkha Mongolian (research)
Programming	Python, R
Software	L ^A T _E X, IBM SPSS, OpenSesame, Praat